

The Dhāraṇī for Thoroughly Purifying Offerings

Dakṣiṇāviśodhanadhāraṇī · Toh 778 · Derge Kangyur

ཡན་ལཱ་སྐྱེ་བའ་གཟུངས།

This short text, known as the Dhāraṇī for Thoroughly Purifying Offerings (Skt. *Dāna-viśodhana-dhāraṇī*; Tib. རྒྱུ་ལྷན་སྐྱེ་བའ་གཟུངས་ཀྱི་ཐུགས་རྒྱུ་ལྷན་སྐྱེ་བའ་གཟུངས་), belongs to the dhāraṇī genre of Buddhist scripture, consisting of a brief invocation and mantra attributed to the Tathāgata Sumerukalparāja. It teaches that the recitation of this formula—centered on the mantra "oṃ kalpe kalpe mahākalpe kalpapariśodhani svāhā"—purifies offerings made to the Three Jewels, rendering them as vast and meritorious as Mount Meru itself, and recommends its repetition some five or six times to ensure this purification. As Toh 778 in the Kangyur, it is part of a broader collection of short dhāraṇī texts used in ritual practice to consecrate and enhance the efficacy of offerings.

Thus concludes the dhāraṇī for thoroughly purifying.

Next, the dhāraṇī for thoroughly purifying offerings:

Namo bhagavate sumerukalparājāya tathāgatāya arhate
samyaksaṃbuddhāya. Tadyathā: oṃ kalpe kalpe mahākalpe kalpapariśodhani
svāhā.

It is taught that reciting this dhāraṇī once purifies offerings equal in measure to Mount Meru. Therefore one should recite it about five or six times.

Thus concludes the dhāraṇī for thoroughly purifying offerings.

Translator's Notes

- The mantra syllables are given as a phonetic reconstruction of the Sanskrit rather than a translation, per convention for dhāraṇī material. "Sumerukalparājāya" likely reflects "sumeru-kalpa-rāja" (King of the Meru-Aeon), addressed to a Tathāgata of that name; the exact reference is uncertain but does not affect the ritual instruction that follows.

Colophon

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Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.